

THE FRIENDS WITH FOUR KEYS: PROSE,

CHAPTER 2 • THE KITCHEN TABLE

2026-09-02. Pipeline step 4 at production scale, chapter 2 of 10, per SAS/prompt-claude-fable-briefs-four-keys-kickoff.md. Ten packages, *fk_p02_01* to *fk_p02_10*, against structure v2.2 Part B (chapter 2 rows) and Part C (D1). Fable wrote every line from redacted briefs, blind to the graph. Every line below is a placeholder until Stephen rules it. Per package: the brief as sent (for audit), then the prose that returned, marked DRAFT.

Blindness record: prose written by a fresh Fable subagent fed only: spine Part G (the public account) · the five v1.2 · cold open v0.4 · ally-voice-reference v1.0 Part A with the Pass 4, warning-sign and listening-speed checks · the story-so-far digest as it stood after chapter 1 · the chapter frame and ten briefs below. No repo access, no memory, zero tool uses across the run and both revision passes. Briefs leak-checked against spine v1.4 before the run; prose leak-checked after. Two revisions, both within licence and both made by the same blind agent: the second letter's ladder line was in the future tense (the fall precedes the letters; Ruby's own account in the same scene has "the week she fell"), rewritten past tense and made to name the fall; and a trade word with a mid-list gloss ("mahlstick") was cut from the boxes beat.

Checks (run 2026-09-02, this session): ① Leak check vs spine v1.4: PASS. No graph fact appears; the standing never-tolds hold (nothing implies either letter is anything but Violet's; the message on the phone is not quoted; Margo carries no private view; the boxes' nothing is stated and left; no audience, no places). ② Voice check (Part A rules, Pass 4, warning signs, registers): PASS, with the three weakest lines named below. No em dashes anywhere. ③ Structure conformance vs Part B: PASS. The one turn (*p02_03*) lands on the reading's mechanism as the row states it; D1 resolves inside *p02_03*'s completion with two options and two results and no consequence shown; *p02_08* is provenance not belief; *p02_10* has one variant per branch. ④ Ruled-text conformance: the sign-off is verbatim in both variants; Ally's three unknowns are restated with one honest adjustment (the door, "beyond Ruby's word for it") that the chapter's own facts require.

Stop-and-report: none. No brief needed a licence widened.

Canon this chapter creates (for Stephen's attention when ruling): the text of Violet's key letter and the text of the second letter now exist as objects. Later chapters read against them. Rule these two documents first; every other line in the chapter is texture around them.

The three weakest lines, named honestly (Stephen reads these first):

1. **p02_04 BEAT:** "Every sentence ends with 'anyway', handed across the table like a plate." A simile of the crafted class Part A rule 1 warns against. The five's own phrase is plainer and available: "as if handing them over."
2. **p02_03 second LETTER:** "I wish he hadn't. I've wished it every day since." The second sentence is the one line in either letter that performs its feeling; Violet is dry everywhere else, including in her other letter. Cutting the second sentence loses nothing the claim needs.
3. **p02_10 both variants:** "She'll go to work at the surgery tomorrow. She'll go down to the slip." A mirrored pair of the kind Trish flagged; the cost is real but it is stated as rhythm rather than fact. One plain sentence would carry it.

Production notes: p02_01's beat is one 90-word paragraph and p02_10's paragraphs run to about 75 words; they split into VO nodes at sentence boundaries when the graphs are built. D1's two RESULT lines are the branch nodes; OPTION A and B are the choice labels (both under nine words). The three p02_06 toasts are one per member card, bar order.

The chapter frame, as sent

CHAPTER 2 BRIEFS • THE KITCHEN TABLE • Ally's second broadcast week

The frame for the whole chapter. Ally's first week of interviews. Ruby Walker has agreed to talk, on record, at her own kitchen table, over several sittings. Everything Ally learns this week comes from four places and nowhere else: Ruby herself; Ruby's own key letter; the second letter, the one from behind the door, which Ruby has kept since the police examined it and gave it back; and the boxes of Brad's things that his landlord sent to Ruby when the flat was cleared, months after he went. Ally has never met Liam and he is still not talking. Ally knows nothing of Margo's partner beyond the public account and does not go near it this week. Ally sources every statement: Ruby says, according to Ruby, the letter says, in Ruby's kitchen. She never claims to know what the police could not find. The chapter's one turn is package 3. Episode 2 airs at the end of package 10.

What Fable writes per package. OPEN: one line, Ally's working note as she sits down to the work, not addressed to the player, never stating the beat's result in advance. BEAT: as each brief says. Where asked: CAPTION (art with caption), LETTER (a document's text), SCENE (speaker labels ALLY and RUBY), TOASTS (one line per member card on the three-card package, in the register of authored narrative micro-beats, noun phrase then a fragment, for example "Mail: days deep" or "The kitchen: packed in the dark"; never a system message), and the D1 block in package 3.

Length discipline. The turn beat may breathe (a short scene, up to about 260 words, plus the letter). Texture beats: one to three sentences, or a short exchange under 90 words. Character-fact beats: under 100 words; the fact stated plainly, never dressed. Toasts: one line. No spoken line over 45 words. No em dashes anywhere. Contractions. Plain over crafted. Say the fact, then turn it. Never narrate the obvious. Uncertainty is grammatical: she said, according to Ruby, I don't know.

Standing never-tolds for this chapter (breaking any of these fails the chapter): never say or imply that either letter is anything but Violet's; never say what any letter will later prove or mean; never speculate what was in Brad's boxes that should have been and wasn't; never speculate where anyone is now, or that anyone might be alive; never quote or paraphrase the words of the message Brad left on his phone (Ruby will not read it out, and Ally respects that); never mention any trip, wedding, race or absence of Brad's; never give Margo a private opinion, a doubt, a calculation or a secret of any kind: she is present in Ruby's account as the five describes her, sharp, early, saying the true thing in the worst way, and that is all; never mention any police procedure beyond the public account; never mention anyone else who might recognise anything Ally airs; never mention downloads, listeners in particular places, or the size of the audience.

fk_p02_01 · D2 · (t)[AL] · Ruby's kitchen

Brief sent:

The first sitting. The table is the table the four worked the letter at, weekly, for months. Ruby Walker, thirty-nine, practice nurse at the surgery on Wharf Street, joined the slip swimmers nine years ago on a patient's advice; Violet said she swam like someone being chased. Every Tuesday for years Ruby texted at six to say she couldn't make the slip, and every Tuesday she came, and the two of them sat in her car with the heater on and had the same argument about whether Ruby's husband should be told. Ruby tells Ally this herself, at the table, before anything else.

Write: OPEN. BEAT: Ally's narration arriving in Ruby's kitchen, three to five sentences, the table and what it was used for as Ruby says it, and the Tuesday heater ritual as Ruby tells it. Ruby may have one spoken line. Never what the room concluded, or whether it was right. Never Ruby's view of Liam or of anyone: not yet.

DRAFT prose:

OPEN: First sitting. Ruby's kitchen, the recorder between us, and she can start wherever she likes.

BEAT:

Ruby Walker's kitchen table is pine, scrubbed pale, and according to Ruby it's the table the four of them sat at every week for months with Violet's letter between them. She tells me that before she tells me anything else. She's thirty-nine, a practice nurse at the surgery on Wharf Street, and she says she joined the slip swimmers nine years ago because a patient told her it helped; Violet, she says, told her she swam like someone being chased. Every Tuesday for years, Ruby says, she texted Violet at six to say she couldn't make it, and every Tuesday she went anyway, and the two of them sat in Ruby's car with the heater on and had the same argument.

RUBY: Whether my husband should be told. That was the argument. Same one every Tuesday, and neither of us ever won it. Anyway.

fk_p02_02 · F2 + A2 · (t)[AC] · the key letter photographed

Brief sent:

The key letter goes on Ally's board: photographed under glass, Violet's handwriting, her exact words, as an object. Ruby reads it on tape. Ruby's copy is one of four identical letters; each of the four received the same words and a key.

Write: OPEN. CAPTION for the photographed letter as it is pinned, one or two lines, plain. LETTER: the full text of the key letter in Violet's own voice, under 140 words, as the four received it. It must contain exactly this and nothing else: that she thinks one of the four of them is planning to kill her; that she doesn't know which one and might be wrong; that they are not to go to the police, and her reason, which is this and only this: she can prove nothing, the police would look and find nothing they could act on, and the one she is afraid of would learn she had been to them; that what she found is behind the door of her locker store at the boatsheds by the slip (RE-RULED 2026-09-03: was "Cage 4, her storage cage at the fish market"), that the padlock is new and these four keys are the only ones; and that they are to open it

together, all four, nobody alone. She is funny in a way that costs (the five); one line may sound like her. The letter names nobody, describes nothing behind the door, gives no grounds for her fear beyond the fact of it, and mentions no craft or trade detail of any kind. Sign it as she would.

DRAFT prose:

OPEN: The letter goes under glass today. Her words, not mine, and Ruby reads them.

CAPTION:

Violet Moore's letter to the four, in her handwriting. This is Ruby Walker's copy; the other three were identical. Photographed under glass at Ruby's kitchen table.

LETTER:

If you've got this, I'm dead, and I'm sorry about the timing.

I think one of you four is planning to kill me. I don't know which. I might be wrong. I've been wrong about people before and I never once enjoyed it.

Please don't go to the police, not yet. I can't prove anything. They'd look, probably find nothing and I'd get labelled as a mad woman shouting at the sky. Also, the one I'm afraid of would know that they've been informed.

What I found is behind the door of my locker at the boatsheds by the slip. The padlock is new. These four keys are the only ones.

Open it together. All four of you. Nobody on their own.

Violet

(KEY LETTER RULED, Stephen 2026-09-03: the police paragraph is his, with the double negative fixed at his choice; "locker" ruled over "lock-up"; every other line stands as drafted.)

fk_p02_03 · A3 + D3 · ★TURN [ET] · the room, meeting by meeting; D1

Brief sent:

Ruby reconstructs the room, meeting by meeting, with the second letter on the table in front of her. Ally hears it and airs it, in whole or in part, by her own choice.

What Ruby tells, in this order, as her own account and nobody else's:

1. The Saturday. The four opened the store together. Inside: a second letter in Violet's handwriting, longer, and beside it a name board, the wooden board off a boat's transom, the kind Violet lettered for a living; this one had hung on a hook in Violet's hall for years and all four of them knew it. They took it that she had put it there herself to tell them something. They read the letter at this table. Weekly meetings were agreed that night.
2. Meeting two, a week on: the letter's line about the boatyard, read against Liam.
3. The next day Liam confirmed it: he owns a third of the yard and has for eight years, and lets the town think he is staff. A thing in the letter was true. Ruby: that was the day it started.

4. Meeting three: the tin. The letter says the money in Violet's tin was Liam's, every quarter since he bought in. Liam said he never gave her a penny. Brad argued: she might have been wrong about the money, and if she was wrong about that she was wrong about the rest, and they could not do this to Liam on a maybe. He lost.
5. Meeting four: the ladder. The letter says she had told Liam which ladder she would be on the week she fell. Liam: she told everyone which ladder.
6. Meeting five: the board, and the money read again beside it.
7. Brad went. One message to the three of them; Ruby will not read it out and Ally does not ask twice.
8. The three kept meeting. Ruby drove it. It landed on Liam. Ruby said it to his face. Liam left and did not come back.

The pattern Ruby names herself: every time the reading wavered, Brad defended Liam, reasonably, and lost, and it came back harder. Ruby's own reading of herself (the five): she reads bodies for a living, can tell a lie from the neck, and stood in that kitchen a hundred times and saw nothing; she has stopped trusting that. Margo is present in the account only as the five has her: sharp, early, saying the true thing in the worst way; she made Ruby cry twice and apologised once. No more about Margo than that.

LETTER: Fable also writes the full text of the second letter, the one from behind the door, under 190 words, in Violet's voice, as Ruby holds it. It must do exactly this: open on certainty, "I know" where the first letter said "I think"; make its claims without ever naming a person, each line leaning the same way: that one of them owns a third of the boatyard and lets the town think he is staff; that he told her, the day he bought in, how he had paid for it, and she wished he hadn't (the letter never says what he did); that he gave her the board in her hall that same day and she hung it where she would see it every morning; that the money in her tin is his, every quarter since, for saying nothing; that she had told him which ladder she would be on the week she fell. It mentions the one she sent up her ladder when she was behind, once, kindly, in passing, without clearing or accusing him. It ends: read this together, and be careful. It must not mention anything found in her workshop, any object other than the board, or any reason beyond the claims themselves.

Write: OPEN. SCENE at the table, Ruby's account in the order above, Ally asking little, up to about 260 words. LETTER as specified. Then the D1 block: PROMPT, Ally deciding what airs, in her voice, under 40 words: read Ruby's second letter whole on air, or air only what Ally can herself verify (that it exists, that it says she knew, that the police examined it and it is hers, that it leans at one man Ally will not name from a dead woman's unverified claims). OPTION A, under nine words, the whole letter aired. OPTION B, under nine words, only the verifiable. RESULT A, one or two sentences of Ally stating the decision and nothing more. RESULT B, the same. No consequences of either choice are shown or promised here.

DRAFT prose:

OPEN: Second sitting, the long one. The other letter is on the table and Ruby's hand is flat on it.

SCENE:

RUBY: The Saturday we opened it together. A second letter, longer, in her handwriting. Beside it a name board, the wooden board off the back of a boat. It'd hung in her hall for years. We all knew it.

RUBY: We took it she'd put it there to tell us something. We read the letter at this table and agreed to meet every week.

RUBY: Week two, the boatyard line, read against Liam. Next day he told us himself. He owns a third of the yard and lets the town think he's staff. Something in it was true. That's the day it started.

RUBY: Week three, the tin. The letter says the money in her tin was his, every quarter since he bought in. Liam said he never gave her a penny.

RUBY: Brad said if she was wrong about the money she was wrong about the rest, and we couldn't do this to Liam on a maybe. He lost.

RUBY: Week four, the ladder. The letter says she'd told Liam which ladder she'd be on the week she fell. Liam said she told everyone. Week five, the board, and the money again beside it.

RUBY: Margo was ten minutes early every week and said the true thing in the worst way. Made me cry twice at this table. Apologised once.

RUBY: Then Brad went. One message, to the three of us. I won't read it out.

ALLY: All right.

RUBY: We kept meeting, the three of us. I drove it. It landed on Liam and I said it to his face, here. He left and didn't come back.

ALLY: You said there was a pattern.

RUBY: Every time it wavered Brad defended Liam, reasonably, and lost, and it came back harder. I read bodies for a living. I can tell a lie from the neck. I stood in this kitchen a hundred times and saw nothing. I don't trust that anymore.

LETTER:

The first letter said I think. This one says I know.

One of you owns a third of the boatyard and has for eight years, and lets the town think he's staff. The day he bought in he told me how he'd paid for it. I wish he hadn't. I've wished it every day since.

He gave me the board in my hall that same day. I hung it where I'd see it every morning.

The money in my tin is his. Every quarter since, for saying nothing.

I'd told him which ladder I'd be on the week I fell. Nobody asked me. I told him myself.

One of you I've sent up my ladder when I was behind. You went. Thank you.

Read this together, and be careful.

Violet

D1

PROMPT: The second letter is on my table. I can read it whole, every line of it leaning at a man who isn't in the room. Or I can air only what I can stand behind myself. Which is it?

OPTION A: Read the whole letter on air.

OPTION B: Air only what I can verify.

RESULT A: I'm reading it whole. Every word is Violet's, and you'll hear all of them in the order she wrote them.

RESULT B: I'm not reading it. I'll say it exists, that it says she knew, that the police examined it and it's hers, and that it leans at one man. His name stays off my tape.

fk_p02_04 · D2×3 · (t)[CF] · frightened, Ruby talks; the glass is tonic

Brief sent:

Frightened, Ruby talks. She fills the room, allocates jobs, makes tea nobody asked for, and ends her own sentences with "anyway", as if handing them over. And the glass in her hand at the end of a long sitting is tonic. She has not had a drink in six years; she lets people assume gin, and it has never come up. The fact is hers to state plainly, once, to Ally, when Ally notices or asks.

Write: OPEN. BEAT: under 100 words, Ally's observation of the talking and the jobs, then Ruby stating the fact in one or two lines. Never link the sobriety to Violet, to the case, to any night, to any call. It explains nothing and it is not made to.

DRAFT prose:

OPEN: Fourth hour at the table. Ruby has made tea three times and I haven't asked once.

BEAT:

Ruby talks. I don't know yet whether it's fear or habit. Over four hours she's given me jobs: hold this, read that, check the recorder's still going. Every sentence ends with "anyway", handed across the table like a plate. Near the end I look at the glass by her hand and she sees me look.

RUBY: It's tonic. I haven't had a drink in six years. People assume gin and I let them. It's never come up.

I say all right, and it doesn't come up again.

fk_p02_05 · A3 · (t)[CF] · the four in the morning call

Brief sent:

On tape. Ruby is the one Violet rang at four in the morning, once, three years ago. Ruby drove over. They never talked about what was said, and when Ruby tried, Violet changed the subject so fast it was like a door closing.

Write: OPEN. BEAT: under 100 words. Ruby tells it. Ally asks once what it was about; Ruby doesn't know and won't guess. The call is never explained, by anyone, and Ally does not try to explain it.

DRAFT prose:

OPEN: On tape today. Ruby says there's one night she wants on the record.

BEAT:

RUBY: Three years ago Violet rang me at four in the morning. Once. Never before, never after. I drove over.

ALLY: What was it about?

RUBY: I don't know. We never talked about what was said. I tried, once, and she changed the subject so fast it was like a door closing. I didn't try again.

I don't ask a second time. I don't know what that call was about, and Ruby says she doesn't either.

fk_p02_06 · R4 + R3 + R3 · (t)[ET] · the boxes, days of careful nothing

Brief sent:

The boxes. Months after Brad went, his landlord cleared the flat and sent everything to Ruby because hers was the name he had. They are in her spare room. Over several days Ally and Ruby go through a man's whole flat in boxes. What a flat holds: clothes; his work things, brushes, tape, a mahlstick, paint tins; mugs; post; a laptop the police had already looked at and given back; his passport and his bank cards, which is why nobody thinks he went anywhere; books. Nothing in it explains anything. Days of careful nothing.

Write: OPEN. TOASTS: three lines, one per card, in the authored micro-beat register, the first box, the middle, the last. BEAT: Ally's lines, up to five sentences, on the nothing, with one short exchange with Ruby. Never speculate what should have been there and wasn't; never say the nothing means anything; never mention any other name, place, paper or trip. The nothing is stated and left.

DRAFT prose:

OPEN: Ruby's spare room. Brad Collins's flat, in boxes, and days to get through it.

TOASTS:

- The first box: clothes, still folded.
- The middle: brushes and tape, a man's work in tins.
- The last box: passport, bank cards, post.

BEAT:

Months after Brad went, Ruby says, his landlord cleared the flat and sent everything to her because hers was the name he had. It's all in her spare room. Over several days we go through it: clothes, brushes, tape, paint tins, mugs, post, books, a laptop the police had already looked at and given back, and his passport and his bank cards. That last pair is why nobody thinks he went anywhere, Ruby says.

RUBY: Is that it?

ALLY: That's it.

Nothing in these boxes explains anything, and I'm not going to pretend it does.

fk_p02_07 · A4 · (t)[CF] · Brad's habits, from Ruby

Brief sent:

Brad's habits, from Ruby, on tape, and Ally airs them as a portrait, not as an appeal. Verbatim from the five, Ruby's words: he put his keys on the table when he sat and moved them twice; he said thank you like it cost him; he was up at five to run. Also hers to give: frightened, Brad joked, then drank, then went still in a way that was not calm, and if you spoke to him then he would answer a question you didn't ask; he swam badly and only in summer and Violet never let him hear the end of it; Ruby loved him without quite respecting him.

Write: OPEN. BEAT: under 110 words, Ruby speaking and Ally framing once ("This is Brad, as Ruby has him", or her own plainer line). Never that anyone might recognise him by these; never "if you knew him"; never anything about where he went or might be.

DRAFT prose:

OPEN: Tape running. I asked Ruby for Brad as he was at this table, not as he was on the front page.

BEAT:

This is Brad, as Ruby has him.

RUBY: He put his keys on the table when he sat and moved them twice. He said thank you like it cost him. He was up at five to run.

RUBY: Frightened, he joked. Then he drank. Then he went still, and it wasn't calm, and if you spoke to him then he'd answer a question you didn't ask.

RUBY: He swam badly and only in summer and Violet never let him hear the end of it. I loved him. I didn't quite respect him. Both of those are true. Anyway.

fk_p02_o8 · F4 + F2 · (t)[ET] · the solicitor's slip

Brief sent:

Ruby kept the envelope her key came in. Inside it, folded behind the letter, the solicitor's covering slip: four sealed envelopes lodged with him on a date three weeks before Violet died, with the instruction to post them after her funeral; the postmark on the envelope is the day after the funeral. Ally already knew the police had confirmed this; now she is holding the paper. She notes the date: Violet's fear was three weeks old when she died, and a solicitor wrote the date down. Provenance, not a new belief.

Write: OPEN. BEAT: under 90 words, Ally's lines and at most one from Ruby. Ally notes the date and what it establishes about when, and nothing else. Never what the date will later matter for; never a conclusion beyond the date.

DRAFT prose:

OPEN: Ruby kept the envelope. I've asked to see what's folded behind the letter.

BEAT:

Behind the letter, folded small, is the solicitor's covering slip. It says four sealed envelopes were lodged with him on a date three weeks before Violet died, to be posted after her funeral. The postmark on Ruby's envelope is the day after the funeral. I knew the police had confirmed this. Now I'm holding the paper. What it tells me

is when: three weeks before she died, Violet was frightened enough to write this down, and a solicitor wrote the date beside it.

RUBY: I never looked at the date. Not once.

fk_p02_09 · D4 · (t)[CF] · the piano

Brief sent:

Sheet music on the piano stand in Ruby's front room, and it is not carols; it is something hard. Ally notices on the way through. Ruby: grade eight at fourteen. The surgery thinks the Christmas carols are the extent of it, and she lets them.

Write: OPEN. BEAT: under 80 words. The fact, plainly, and Ally leaves it exactly where it is. It has no bearing on anything and Ally must not make it mean anything.

DRAFT prose:

OPEN: Through the front room on the way out. There's a piano I hadn't noticed.

BEAT:

On the stand there's sheet music, and it isn't carols. It's something hard.

RUBY: Grade eight at fourteen. The surgery thinks the Christmas carols are the extent of it. I let them.

I leave it where it is.

fk_p02_10 · A3 · (t)[AL] · Ep 2 publishes, two variants

Brief sent:

Ally's close for the week, in two variants, one per D1 branch. What aired: Ruby's kitchen and the table; the meetings as Ruby tells them; the letters (VARIANT AIRED: the second letter read whole; VARIANT HELD: the second letter described only as it exists, that it says she knew, that the police examined it and it is hers, that it leans at one man Ally will not name from unverified claims); the boxes and their nothing; Brad's habits as a portrait. And what airing cost Ruby: her name on it now, in a small city; the surgery; the slip; the other survivor hearing her account before hearing his own. Ally restates her unknowns honestly (the same three, unchanged, in her own words). End with the ruled sign-off, verbatim: "This is Echoes of Havenbay, I'm Ally Quinn. Goodnight for now, Harbour. Sleep tight."

Write: OPEN (one line, the same for both variants). BEAT AIRED and BEAT HELD, each under 170 words. Never the audience, never numbers, never who might be listening or where. Ally promises nothing about next week beyond that Liam still hasn't answered.

DRAFT prose:

OPEN: Week's end. Ruby's week, and what it cost her, before the sign-off.

BEAT AIRED:

That's Ruby Walker's kitchen, and the table where four people read a dead friend's letter every week for months. You've heard the meetings as Ruby tells them. You've heard both letters, the first in Violet's words and the second read whole, every line of it. You've heard the boxes from Brad's flat, and that they hold a man's ordinary things and nothing that explains anything. And you've heard Brad as Ruby has him, keys on the table, up at five.

Here's what this week cost Ruby. Her name is on this now, in a small city. She'll go to work at the surgery tomorrow. She'll go down to the slip. And the other survivor has heard her account of him before anyone has heard his own.

I don't know what was behind that door beyond Ruby's word for it. I don't know whether Violet really identified her killer. And I don't know whether Liam or Ruby has a reason to be afraid.

Liam still hasn't answered.

This is Echoes of Havenbay, I'm Ally Quinn. Goodnight for now, Harbour. Sleep tight.

BEAT HELD:

That's Ruby Walker's kitchen, and the table where four people read a dead friend's letter every week for months. You've heard the meetings as Ruby tells them. You've heard the first letter in Violet's words. The second you haven't, and that's my choice. It exists. I've held it. It says she knew where the first said she thought. The police examined it and it's hers. And it leans at one man on claims nobody has been able to check, and I won't put his name to it. You've heard the boxes from Brad's flat, and that they explain nothing. And you've heard Brad as Ruby has him.

Here's what this week cost Ruby. Her name is on this now, in a small city. She'll go to work at the surgery tomorrow. She'll go down to the slip. And the other survivor has heard her account of him before anyone has heard his own.

I don't know what was behind that door beyond Ruby's word for it. I don't know whether Violet really identified her killer. And I don't know whether Liam or Ruby has a reason to be afraid.

Liam still hasn't answered.

This is Echoes of Havenbay, I'm Ally Quinn. Goodnight for now, Harbour. Sleep tight.
